

Second Terminal Examination - 2079

Class: XI

Subject: C. English (0031)

Full Marks: 75

Time: 3 hrs.

SET A

Pass Marks: 30

Candidates are required to give their answers in their own words as far as practicable. The figures in the margin indicate full marks.

1. Read the following text and do the following tasks per instructions.

To the general consumer, the Ouija board is seen as simply another game on the shelf in a toy store. The average person may perhaps liken it to Monopoly, Snakes and Ladders, and other such board games on the market. The question of how the Ouija board was created and by whom does not generally suppose an area of concern to the average person. Some board games do have simple histories-someone came up with the concept and marketed it. The Ouija board, on the other hand, has a long and complicated history involving spiritualism, the occult, and automatic writing, to name just a few of its influences.

In exploring the history of Ouija had two forms or types of history are considered: "official" and "folk." According to the Encyclopedia of Occultism and Parasychology, the word Ouija is derived from the French "oui" and the German "ja" both of which mean 'yes'. The Ouija board is defined as an "apparatus for psychic communication" that "consists of a wooden tripod on rollers, which under the hand of the medium moves over a polished board and spells out messages by pointing out letters with its apex" ("Ouija Board" 989).

Some people think that the Ouija board is relatively new. People have been using similar devices for thousands of years to help them make decisions, find peace of mind in times of trouble, diagnose illness or find cures, receive guidance from God, speak with dead loved ones and foretell the future. (Covina 10). As far back as 540 B.C., the philosopher Pythagoras used a device quite similar to the above Ouija board description. It is noted in a historical account of his life that his sect would hold seances whereby a table on wheels would move toward signs. These signs were then interpreted by Pythagoras and his pupil, Philolaus, as revelations from the unseen world.

Along with Pythagoras's version of the Ouija board, other variations have been used throughout history in different areas of the world. According Stoker Hunt in *Ouija: the Most Dangerous Game*, the Ouija board is "nothing less than a folk knowledge, a universal folk instrument" since it has been reinvented and rediscovered by many different people in a wide variety of locations in the world. Hunt's comments suggest that no one person or place can be accredited with its discovery. He noted that in China, for example, around

551-479 B.C., the use of a Ouija-like instrument was fairly common and no one considered it to be dangerous to try to communicate with the dead. Hunt also pointed out that reports from third century A.D. Rome indicate the use of such a device. Traditional narrative holds that there were three people experimenting with the Ouija board who decided to ask for the name of the successor to the throne. When they announced their findings, they were tried for treason and the person they had named as successor, a soldier named Theodosius, was executed. Hunt indicated that thirteenth century Tartary also saw the use of a Ouija-like device that was used for divination and instruction by the Mongols. He said, however, that one of the earliest traces of a Ouija-like device in North America can be credited to the Native population. Long before Columbus arrived, Natives were said to use devices called "squidilatic boards" in order to find lost items or people. The boards had symbols on them instead of an alphabet, which directed individuals as to how and when certain religious rituals should take place.

While various types of Ouija-like devices have been used for thousands of years, one can see a connection to spiritualism when one looks at the whole phenomenon as it presents itself today.

A. Mark (rewriting) the statements: *True, False, or Not Given.* (5×1 = 5)

- a. Common people yearn to be acquainted with the history of the origin of Ouija.
- b. The Ouija board game has an antique, intricate, and cabalistic history.
- c. The board game is thought to rectify the satanic possession.
- d. Covino narrates the five utilities of the Ouija board game.
- e. In China, people used the Ouija board to communicate with the demonic deceased ones.

B. Match the statements of column A with their correct pair from column B. (5×1 = 5)

Column A

Column B

- | | |
|--|--|
| a. In the 3 rd century Rome, three people used Ouija to | i. To predict the auspicious date for rituals |
| b. The native population of North America used the board game | ii. Property trading board game |
| c. Apparatus for psychic communication | iii. Stoker's conception of the Ouija board |
| d. Monopoly | iv. Ouija board |
| e. Universal folk instrument | v. Know about the next successor on the throne |

C. Answer the following questions. (5×1 = 5)

- a. What does Hunt's research suggest on the origin of the Ouija board game?
- b. What did Mongols use Ouija for?
- c. How Native Americans' kind of board game differed from the rest of the world?

- d. Why would Pythagoras and Philolaus organize séances?
- e. How does page “989” of the Encyclopedia of Occultism and Parapsychology derive the definition of Ouija?

2. Write short answers to the following questions. (5×2 = 10)

- a. “The Oval Portrait” suggests that the woman's beauty condemns her to death. Discuss in brief.
- b. Why did Makar disclose that he had killed the merchant? (*God Sees the Truth but Waits*)
- c. In the last stanza, the speaker uses the imagery of distance which further connotes separation. Why do you think the speaker is so vehement in his devotion to her? (*A Red, Red Rose*)
- d. What does the slogan “Stay hungry; stay foolish” mean to you? (*How to Live Before You Die*)
- e. What is the central message of the poem, *Corona Says*?

3. Write long answers to the following questions. (2×5 = 10)

- a. “A person is an ultimate loser in the game of life.” Justify the statement concerning the poem, *All the World's a Stage*.
- b. ‘A character's credibility is determined by the character's thoughts and actions and by what others say and think about him or her. Discuss the characters of *Trifles*.

4. Please write a letter to the subject teacher explaining the topic and the content of the recent classroom presentation, and ask him/her for some feedback (150 words) (7)

5. Superstition is prevalent in every walk of life. Can education bring change in the belief of such superstition? Discuss with arguments (180 words) (8)

6. Write an essay on “The Need for Green and Recreational Areas in Cities,” highlighting the problems and suggesting the necessary policies and strategies the authority should follow. (300 words) (10)

7. Do as indicated in brackets and rewrite the sentences. (10×1 = 10)

- a. After a while, he retook her hand. (*Identify the word class of the underlined word*)
- b. As their conversation continued, she became..... (*more and more suspicious/so suspiciously that*) of the strange-looking gentleman. (*Choose the best option*)
- c. The sun shall never setso glorious a human achievement! (*Put the correct preposition in the blank*)
- d. I..... (not/be) there for ages. (*Fill in the blank with the correct verb form*)
- e. His excuses..... (may/shall/will) be accurate, but I don't believe them. (*Choose the best option*)
- f. He promises they (deliver) the package. (*Choose either: ‘will’ or ‘going to’ and complete the sentence*)

- g. Neither the textbook nor the lectures (*provide/provides*) the kind of detailed information. (*Choose the best option*)
- h. Although the mansion was costly, it was very comfortable. (*Rewrite the sentences with either: Nonetheless/Since/Despite*)
- i. Shreya loves creating Instagram reels. She is a professional dancer. (*Join the sentences with a relative pronoun*)
- j. He seems to be delighted with his current job. (*Write whether the underlined verb is transitive, intransitive, or linking*)

8. Do as instructed.

(5×1 = 5)

- a. Arrange the following words in the correct alphabetical order:
jackassery, jaboticaba, jackanapes, jaborandis, jackarooed, jacarandas,
- b. Which consonant sound remains unpronounced in the word 'thumb'? *Mark it with an underline.*
- c. He considered it a trick of his whimsical fate to have searched for the sea without finding it at the cost of countless sacrifices and suffering. The **antonym** of the above-underlined word is:
 - i. Boring
 - ii. Unusual
 - iii. Fanciful
 - iv. bizarre
- d. The following are the primary colors red blue, and yellow. (*Rewrite the sentences using correct punctuation signs*).
- e. He belled the cat when he was trying to escape the prison. *Choose the correct meaning of the underlined idiom:*
 - i. Got himself caught
 - ii. Took the risk
 - iii. Spoiled the whole plan

❧ - The End - ❧